07 / WORKSHOP REFERENCE

Your first connected workflow

A configuration and testing recipe. This is not an installed integration or an importable template.

This is a plan to configure and test, not an installed integration or importable template.

Goal: a new enquiry becomes one internal record and a draft for an owner to review.

Start with synthetic enquiries. Keep automatic sending disabled.

1. Trigger

Choose the form or inbox your team already uses. A structured form is easier to start with than unstructured messages. Capture enquiry ID, client label, service, area, requested date and contact channel. Do not include unnecessary sensitive information.

2. Validate

Require an ID and enough scope to know the next step. For our cleaning example, missing window count, size, height or access puts the record on hold. A budget is not your quoted price; a requested date is not availability.

3. Deduplicate

Check the stable enquiry ID before creating a record. Retrying a failed run must not create another enquiry or another message. Resolve missing details on the same record.

4. Record

Map the agreed fields into a spreadsheet or CRM you already own. Suggested fields: ID, received time, client, scope, missing details, status, draft, reviewer, last error. Keep your own business's retention and access rules.

5. Draft

Start with an approved template. Add an AI step only where it helps: summarising messy notes or adapting the reply. Supply facts and boundaries; store a draft rather than sending it. Product subscriptions and API/automation usage can be separate costs.

6. Review

An owner checks scope, budget wording, dates and recipient. A human sends the approved reply in the usual app. A later automated send needs an explicit approval gate in the real workflow, not simply a button drawn on a diagram.

7. Fail Visibly

Route missing information, invalid model output or a failed app connection to the owner. Preserve the original enquiry and error. Do not silently discard it or keep retrying an outbound action indefinitely.

07 / Test before connecting

Make failure visible.

Five Tests Before Real Use

- Complete enquiry: one record, one draft, no automatic sending.
- Missing windows: hold; no approval until clarified.
- Same ID twice: one record only.
- App or AI step fails: visible error and human handoff.
- Edited/clarified record: same ID, revised draft, fresh review.

Choose a tool based on supported apps and maintainability:

Make - official setup reference

Zapier - official setup reference

n8n - official setup reference

Recommendations are conditional fit judgments. Confirm current plan, connections, usage costs and ownership before enabling the real flow.